

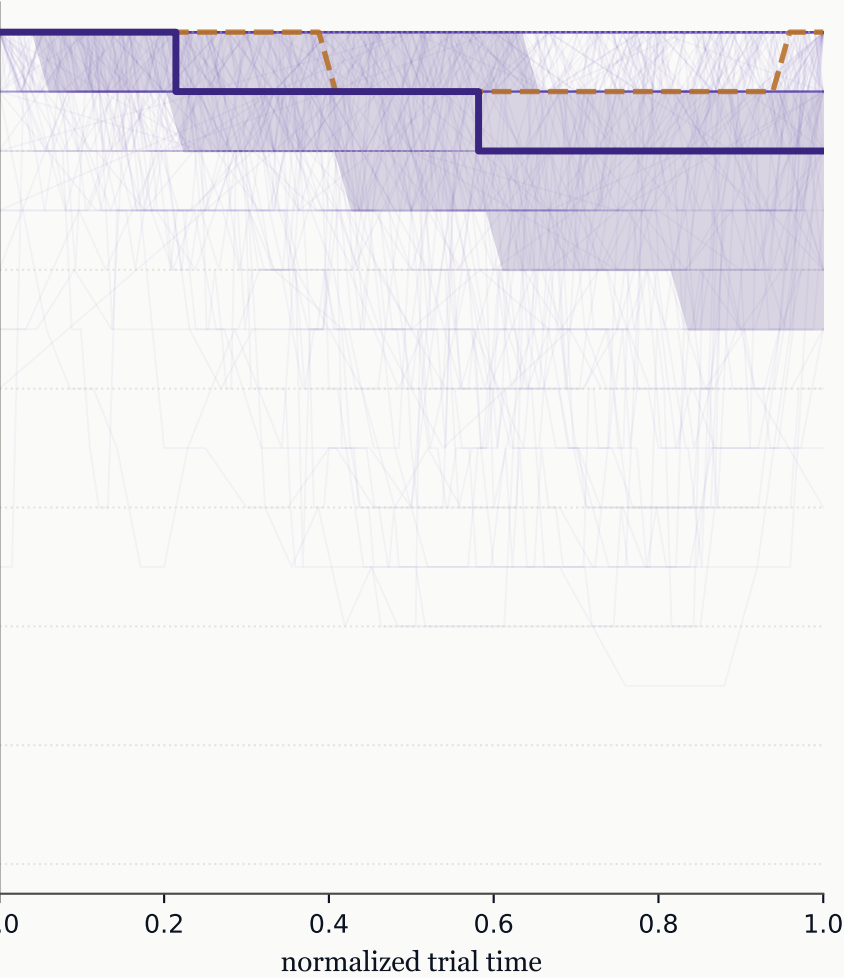
Regress-scan-regress structure by participant strategy — [bbox-organic] · three terciles of per-participant regression rate

Definition: an "epoch" is a contiguous forward push of the high-water-mark (HWM = deepest rank reached).

A new epoch begins when the user, after regressing below HWM, advances HWM beyond its prior max — i.e., resumes scanning into territory not yet visited.

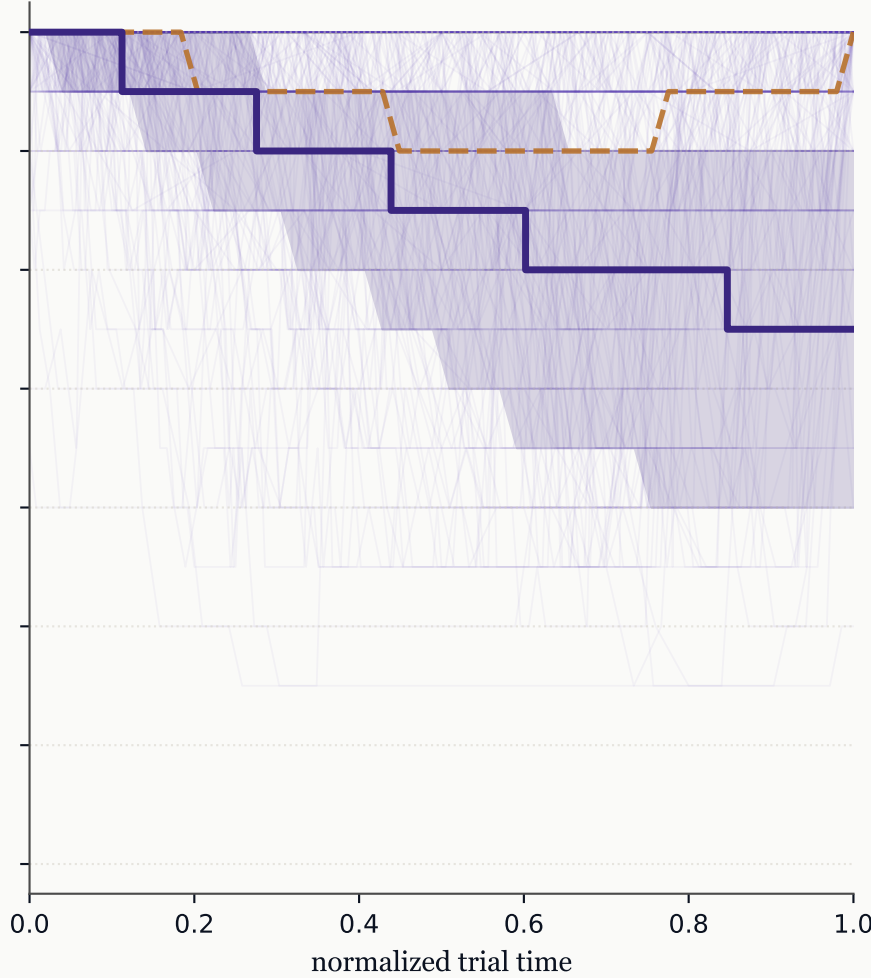
n_epochs = 1 □ pure forward (any regressions did not later push the HWM further). n_epochs = 2 □ one regress-scan-regress cycle. n_epochs ≥ 3 □ multiple cycles. "% multi-cycle" below = trials with n_epochs ≥ 2.

Satisficer (low regression rate)



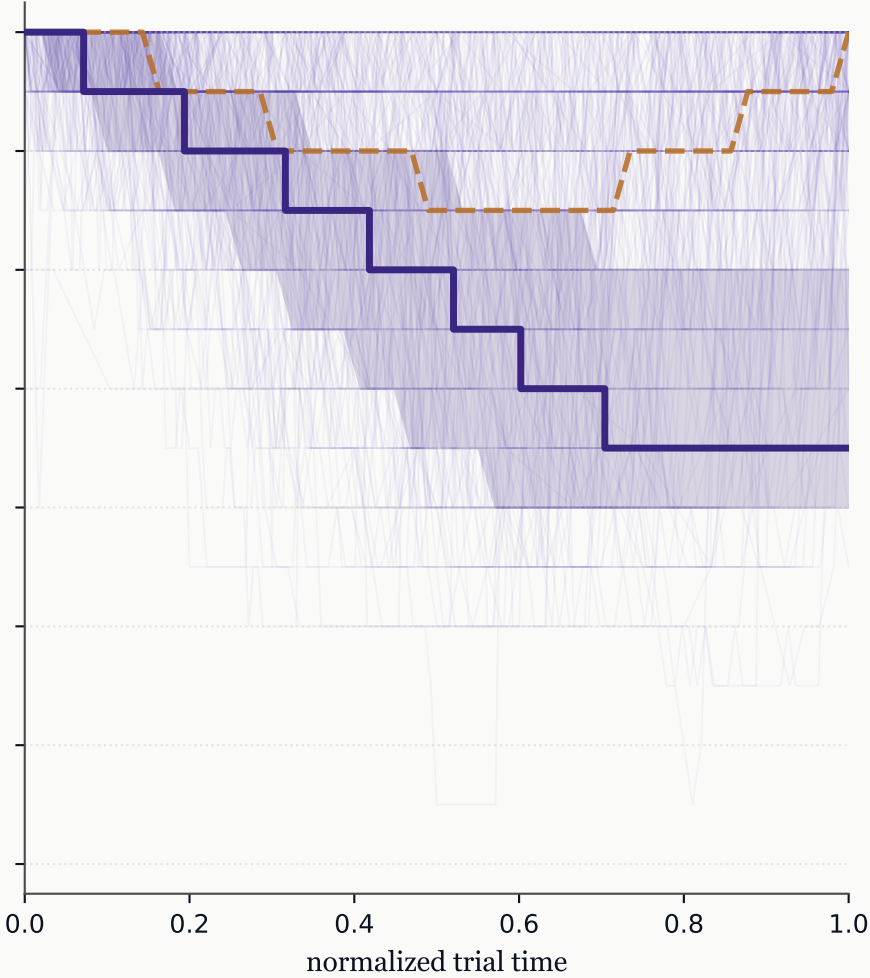
15 participants · 808 trials · median regression rate 0.80
39% multi-cycle · median n_epochs 1 · median 25 fixations

Mid



17 participants · 988 trials · median regression rate 0.93
62% multi-cycle · median n_epochs 2 · median 44 fixations

Optimizer (high regression rate)



15 participants · 885 trials · median regression rate 1.00
85% multi-cycle · median n_epochs 3 · median 63 fixations

— median HWM (the staircase) — median position fixated (the dips) ■ HWM IQR (P25-P75)